

Profile

NAME	Aliaksei Kozel (formerly Aliaksei Pashkel)
DEPT	Strategy / Operations / Production
LOCATION	Minsk, Belarus
RESIDENCY	Belarus
EMAIL	aliaksei@kozel.red
AGE	39

Skills

- Strategic Planning
- Operations
- Production
- Prioritizing
- Risk Forecasting + Mitigation
- Flexibility
- Transparency
- Analytics
- UX Design

Technical Tools

- Project Management:
  - Jira & Confluence
- Game Engines:
  - UE / Unity / Proprietary

Hobbies

- Meditation
- Mind-Body Discipline
- Volunteering
- Vibe Coding

Languages

- English - C2
- Belarusian - C1
- Russian (Native)

Education

Minsk State Linguistic University
Bachelor's in English Literature
2005–2012

Experience

Director of Operations @ Magic Media
Feb 2024 – Sep 2025 // Ireland

– Led operations across several legal entities for ~20 AA+ titles.
– Steered P&L to bring transparency to "misc" expenses with no clear ROI, saving R&D budget.
– Sunset "pet" projects with no path to production.
– Optimized bench mgmt reducing idle time w/ dynamic talent pooling from cross-project staffing.
– Standardized Jira workflows for a number of projects reducing cross-team dependencies.

Director of Production @ Fracture Labs
Jun 2022 – Feb 2024 · 1 yr 9 mos // Singapore

Worked on Decimated, AA+, an MMO TPS for PC and Console.

– Reworked & phased out product scope (multiple iterations).
– Streamlined team structure to re-define responsibilities and pipelines.
– Built & managed: Engineering, Design, DevOps, Tech Art, Animation, VFX, Recruitment.
– Introduced new studio task management & automation tools.
– Introduced & maintained Agile as continuous improvement practices.
– Reworked knowledge-base structure, fueling its quality & depth.

Game Producer @ CM Games
Mar 2022 - Jul 2022 · 5 mos // Estonia

– Revamped LiveOps leading global updates optimizing live events, car economies & balancing, IAP pricing, etc.
– Reduced rollout delays from 3 weeks to healthy "2 days" with kill-switch feature enabled (multi-platform updates).

Released:
✔ a number of updates to Nitro Nation, a popular game in the Racing genre

Co-founder @ Payara Games
Mar 2020 - Mar 2022 · 2 yrs // Belarus

– Pioneered award-winning survival horror game development in Eastern Europe.
– Developed 5+ mobile & web games powered by the latest NFC and smart chip technologies.

Released:
✔ a PC game in the Horror genre inspired by P.T. on Steam
– "Best PC Game" & "Best Art" @ Games Gathering
– "True Indie" @ BelGameDev (nominated by WarHorse Studios)
– "People's Choice" & "Best Game" @ WebCon
✔ a PC game in the Adventure / Horror genres on Steam
– "The Finalist" @ Unreal Engine Dev Contest
✔ 5 mobile & web games in the Charitable Gaming / Lottery / Casino genres powered by NFC

Co-founder @ Abelana VR Productions, Inc.
Mar 2018 - Mar 2022 · 4 yrs // United States

– Pioneered & developed educational VR experiences and tools.
– Developed a platform & 5+ games/apps blending science, education, and latest visionary technologies.

Released:
✔ a VR game featuring Atoms and Orbitals + mobile companion app
✔ a VR game featuring Speed Of Light + mobile game
✔ a VR game featuring String Theory
✔ a distribution platform for educational VR apps (including 3rd-party ones)
✔ a VR experience featuring Romina Russell, the US writer and author of famous Zodiac series
✔ a VR app for online metaverse collaboration

Co-founder @ Iridescent Studio, Ltd.
Mar 2016 - Mar 2022 · 6 yrs // Belarus

– Pioneered subscription monetization in mobile gaming, mastered with A/B testing & predictive analytics.
– Developed 10+ games/apps blending entertainment, brain science, and mindfulness.

Released:
✔ 3 mobile games in the Board game genre
✔ a mobile app with 50+ different brain-training mini-games approved by neuroscientists
✔ an AA mobile multiplayer online game in the RTS genre
✔ a web platform for skill-based cash mobile games
✔ 10+ hyper-casual games with various gameplay mechanics
✔ 2 mental health mobile gamified apps with hundreds of unique meditation content items

✔ 2 emoji apps featuring celebrities (Zayn Malik, Kevin Durant)

Project Manager @ Omertex
Aug 2014 - Feb 2016 · 1.5 yr

Project Manager @ Cactus
Sep 2011 - Aug 2012 · 1 yr

Business Development Manager @ Artezio
Aug 2012 - Jul 2013 · 1 yr

Business Development Manager @ Svyaznoy
Oct 2009 - Mar 2011 · 1.5 yr

Recommendations

"Working with Aliaksei was genuinely a great experience. He jumped straight into a huge amount of responsibility and managed it all with a calm and steady attitude. No matter how complex or unexpected the situation was, he kept his cool and solved problems across a really wide spectrum of operational challenges. What makes him stand out is how adaptable he is. Big systems, lots of moving parts, constant changes and challenges — he was able to quickly find his way, connect the dots, and keep things running smoothly. Aliaksei is the kind of teammate you want around: adaptable, reliable, constructive, and a pleasure to work with."
— Aleksandar Đokić

"What always stood out to me about Aliaksei was his dedication and precision. Every detail mattered to him, and he consistently delivered work of the highest quality. At the same time, he brought a touch of humour and lightness that made even the most intense projects enjoyable to be part of. I truly valued our collaboration and would happily work with Aliaksei again in the future."
— Paulina Swiatkowska

"I have had the pleasure of working with Aliaksei for the last couple of years. He is a true leader. He has built a loyal, hard-working team. He's inquisitive, willing to learn and is relentless to get the facts. He has an enormous amount of integrity when it comes to his commitments and will not stop until he's successful. We have thrown a huge variety of challenges at him, and he always comes through. Aliaksei comes with my highest recommendation."
— Mitzi McGilvray

"As a true professional, Aliaksei made our cooperation in software development not only effective, clear and fast but also smooth and pleasant. He is extremely attentive to detail, passionate about the quality of each project, focused on the clients' needs and able to estimate most of the risks at the very first stage of planning. He's open to new information, constantly improves his skills and is eager to master new spheres and to become an even better professional. It has always been a pleasure to work with him on different projects, and I hope our cooperation will continue in future. I would definitely recommend Aliaksei for any position he is interested in, since he will be a valuable asset for every company in game or business software development."
— Vera Gavryushina

"Aliaksei is the best producer I have ever worked with. He forms an excellent vision of the project very quickly, knows how to correctly set and prioritize tasks. He has excellent long-term and short-term planning skills. He is perfectly organized and does not miss even the smallest details. He has good technical knowledge and excellent understanding of the technical aspects of processes. Last but not the least, Aliaksei is a wonderful, kind, sympathetic person, with high emotional intelligence and great soft skills."
— Anna Ivanova

"Aliaksei is the most client-oriented person I've ever known. Working with him was an absolute pleasure. He is extremely reliable — if he gives a promise he not only has respect for it, he always surpasses expectations both in timing and in quality. I can definitely recommend Aliaksei as a highly-qualified specialist in a very broad range of fields and especially as a person who makes you eager to get up earlier and rush to the office in order to conform to his unparalleled working standards."
— Irina Gusinskaya

"Aliaksei has a great talent for building processes that actually work — not just on paper — and for aligning teams across projects and departments. He is always deeply involved in what's happening on a project, anticipates potential challenges before they become problems, and helps the team navigate them smoothly. He is an exceptional crisis manager. I've seen him take on projects that seemed impossible to turn around, and with his leadership, they not only got back on track but often exceeded expectations. I highly recommend Aliaksei to any organization looking for a leader who can both stabilize and grow teams and projects."
— Alex Petukh

"Aliaksei is an exceptionally versatile and talented game development specialist who also stands out for his clarity, honesty, and thoughtful feedback. He creates a comfortable and friendly work environment, always focusing on results. He is also a kind, positive, and inspiring person. I highly recommend him and look forward to working with him in the future."
— Tatiana Sehen

"Aliaksei is one of the most dedicated professionals I've worked with. It was a pleasure to work with him on various tasks and problems. He is a responsible, hard-working person, always full of useful ideas and suggestions on how to make work better. Aliaksei is result oriented, very attentive to details and a good communicator. I highly recommend Aliaksei and would love to work with him again."
— Olga Truhina

"Aliaksei is an educated and inspiring pro who works with several software development teams. I've had the pleasure of knowing him for about a year now, as we have worked together on several corporate initiatives. He has shown significant knowledge about methodological (e.g. Scrum or Kanban), HR-related, and UX-specific aspects in a broad sense. Above all, I was impressed with his abilities to focus on results and keep everybody informed. And, of course, his open nature and hard working habits, which helped us stay healthy as a team and deliver on time. Aliaksei would be a true asset for any positions requiring a development management jedi."
— Elizabeth Nova

"Aliaksei is one of the smartest, nicest, and most capable people that I've ever worked with. He has the perfect balance of business knowledge, technical capability, and product development experience and skill to manage and drive every project that he's been involved in to great success. He is hard-nosed when he has to be, knows when to be flexible, and is able to mentor both product and technical staff very effectively. I'd recommend Aliaksei in a heartbeat and look forward to working together with him whenever we can."
— Mike Lindelsee

"I have been working with Aliaksei for several years, and those were full of inspiration. He is the mentor in my career and professional growth, working with him is a pleasure and challenge. He is always ready to provide guidance to his colleagues, give a chance to join even with less skills than required in a particular area, be a support for them, unite them, and well ... "kick asses" to get things done. It is a great opportunity to work in Aliaksei's team and deliver great products together!"
— Sergei Lebedzev